Drone-Delivered Gel Speeds Healing on Ukraine's Front Lines

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A gel made in Calgary, Canada, is now helping wounded soldiers and **civilians** in Ukraine. Drones fly the gel, called **NanoSALV Catalytic**, to the **front lines**. NanoTess made it, and Health Canada approved it in 2022. It was first tested by helping **unhoused** people living in camps, and it is now used for **military purposes**. The gel is light and does not catch fire. It goes straight onto a wound, and people with little medical training can use it. Since June, it has treated 6,000 wounded soldiers and **civilians**. Tiny materials in the gel help the body heal faster, use less energy to heal, and fight germs. Hailie Uren, who has worked for four years in eastern Ukraine for the Ukrainian Ministry of Health, says it buys time when one nurse must care for up to 90 patients. NanoTess co-founder and CEO Megan Leslie says the company started with a grant from National Defence in 2020. The gel was also used in Canada after a wildfire at Canadian Forces Base Wainwright killed four soldiers and burned dozens more.

Word Treasure

NanoSALV Catalytic -- This is the name of the gel that helps wounds heal faster.

civilians -- Civilians are ordinary people who are not soldiers.

unhoused -- Unhoused people do not have a home to live in.

front lines -- The front lines are the places closest to the fighting in a war.

military purposes -- Military purposes means uses connected to soldiers and the armed forces.

Background you need

A wound gel is a soft substance that is put straight onto a cut or burn to help it heal.

When many people are hurt at once and nurses are far away, a simple treatment that needs little training can buy time until fuller care arrives.

Drones are small flying machines that can carry supplies quickly to places that are hard to reach.

Break it down

WHO: NanoTess, Hailie Uren, Megan Leslie, and wounded soldiers and civilians in Ukraine
WHAT: A light gel that is flown by drone to wounds and helps the body heal faster
WHERE: Ukraine's front lines, and Calgary, Canada, where the gel was made
WHY: To help wounded people heal when medical workers are stretched thin and full care is far away

Why it matters

Knowing that simple first aid can help someone while waiting for a doctor matters if you or a friend ever gets hurt at school or on a trip.

Test what you remember

1. Who made the gel called NanoSALV Catalytic?

- (A) Health Canada
- (B) The Ukrainian Ministry of Health
- (C) NanoTess
- (D) National Defence

2. How is the gel carried to the front lines?

- (A) By drones
- (B) By boat
- (C) By train
- (D) By horse

3. Who was the gel first tested by helping?

- (A) Soldiers at a base
- (B) Unhoused people living in camps
- (C) Nurses in hospitals
- (D) Visitors to Calgary

4. What do the tiny materials in the gel help the body do?

- (A) Heal faster and fight germs
- (B) Grow taller
- (C) Stay warm in winter
- (D) Sleep longer

5. Where was the gel also used after a wildfire?

- (A) Eastern Ukraine
- (B) Calgary
- (C) National Defence headquarters
- (D) Canadian Forces Base Wainwright

6. Who said the gel buys time when one nurse must care for many patients?

- (A) Megan Leslie
- (B) A soldier at the base
- (C) Hailie Uren
- (D) A nurse in Calgary

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: B 4: A 5: D 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Hailie Uren: The gel buys time when one nurse must care for up to 90 patients.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):